Sugar Cosmetics on Instagram: what really drives engagement?

Content performance analysis · 50,000 posts · Apr 2024 – Apr 2025

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50K
posts

987M
reach

18.55%
engagement rate

ACCOUNT SCORECARD

Huge reach, steady output, 18.55% engagement rate

50,000

posts published

~4,170 per full month

1.28B

impressions

77.4% become unique reach

987.4M

reach

19.7K per post on average

147.7M

likes

81% of all engagement

18.5M

comments

1.9% of reached users comment

8.87M

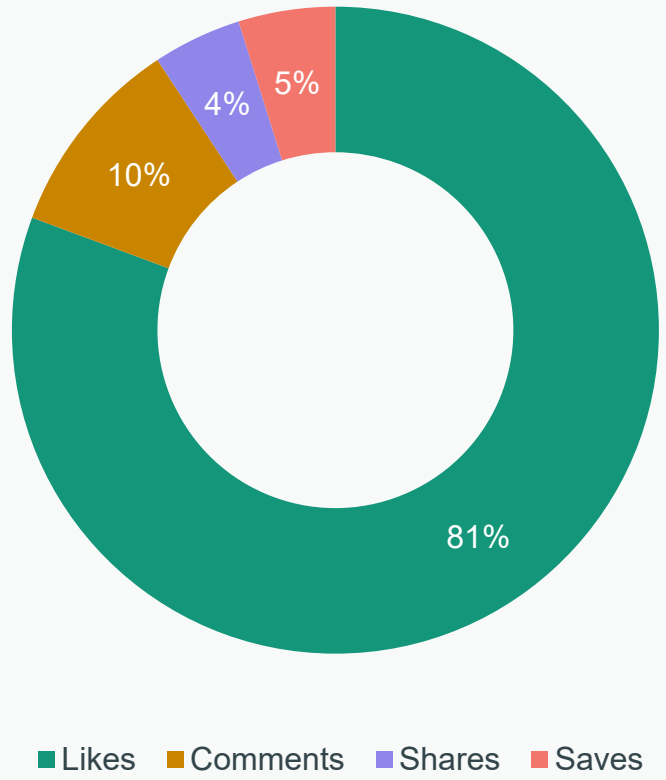
new follows

29.9% of profile visitors

INSIGHT 1 · FUNNEL

Engagement is wide but shallow: 4 in 5 interactions are likes

Engagement mix

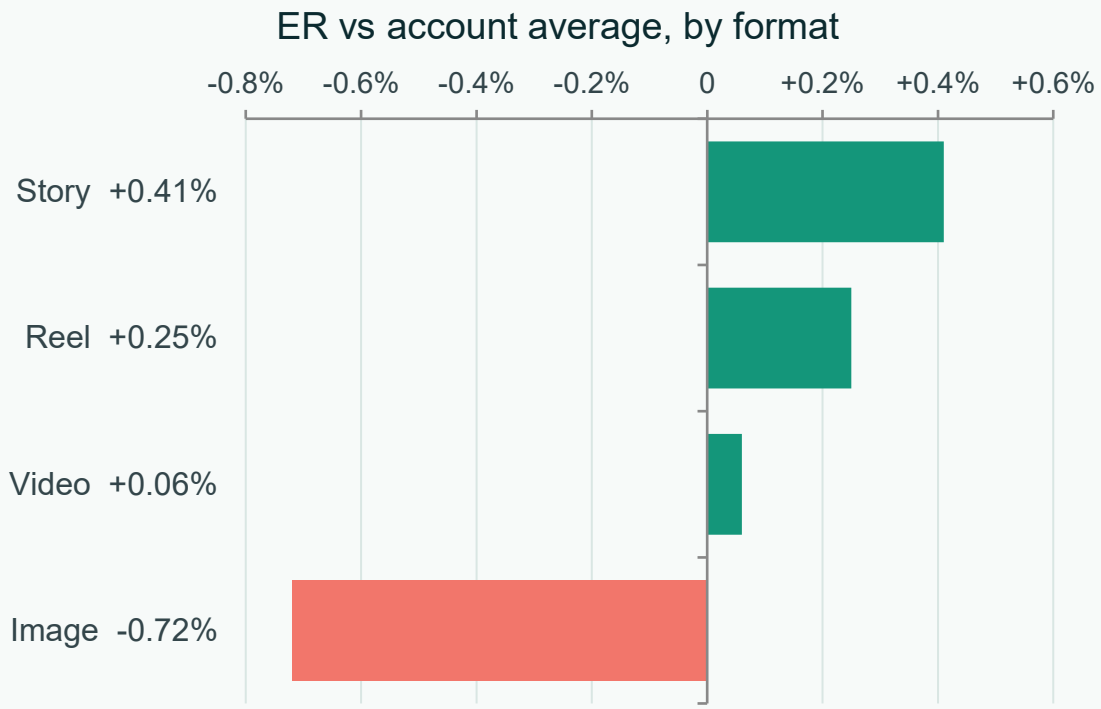


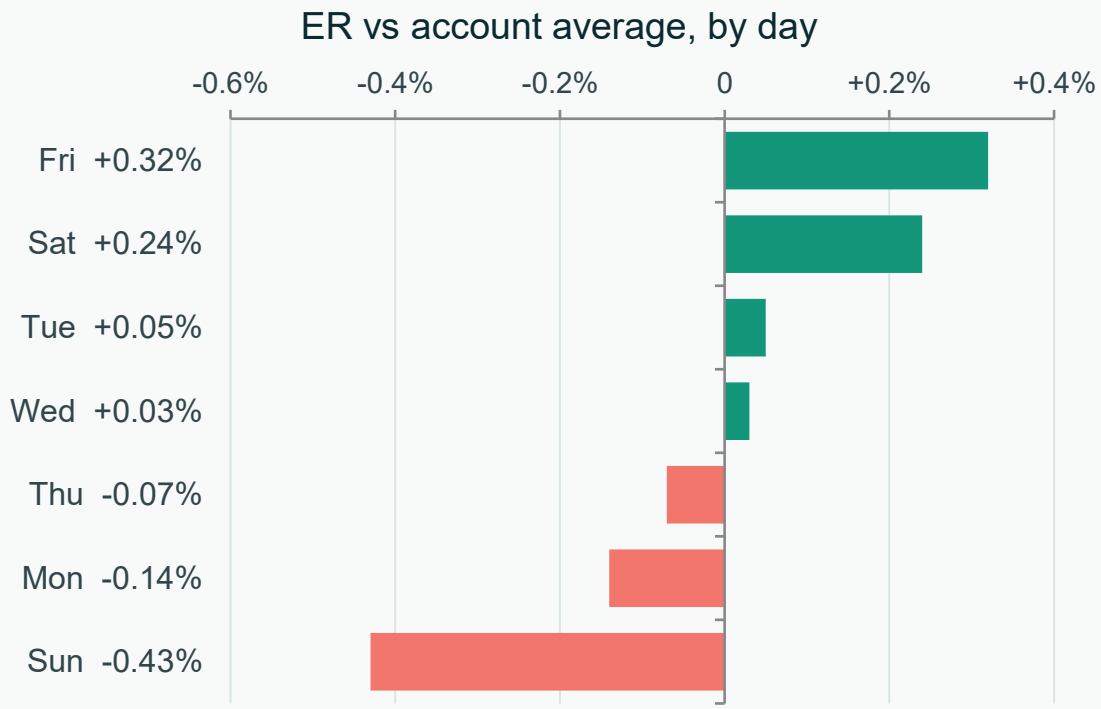
Conversion at each step

Impressions → Reach	**77.4%**
Reach → Like	**15.0%**
Reach → Comment	**1.87%**
Reach → Save	**0.90%**
Reach → Share	**0.82%**
Profile visit → Follow	**29.9%**

INSIGHT 2 · FORMAT & TIMING

Stories and Reels lead; Friday and Saturday win

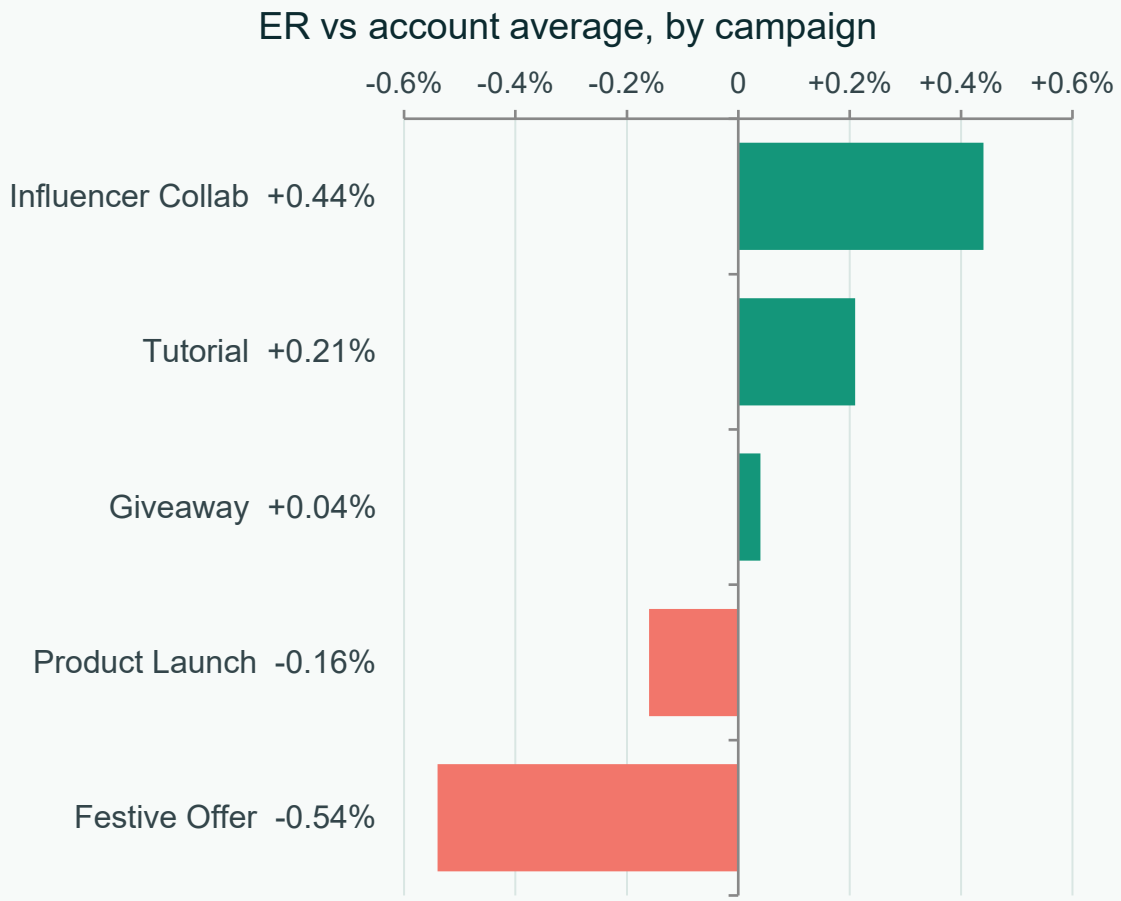




Best single slot: Story on Saturday (18.76%) · Reel on Wednesday (18.73%) · Reel on Friday (18.70%)

INSIGHT 3 · CAMPAIGNS

Tutorials and creator collabs win; static festive offers lag



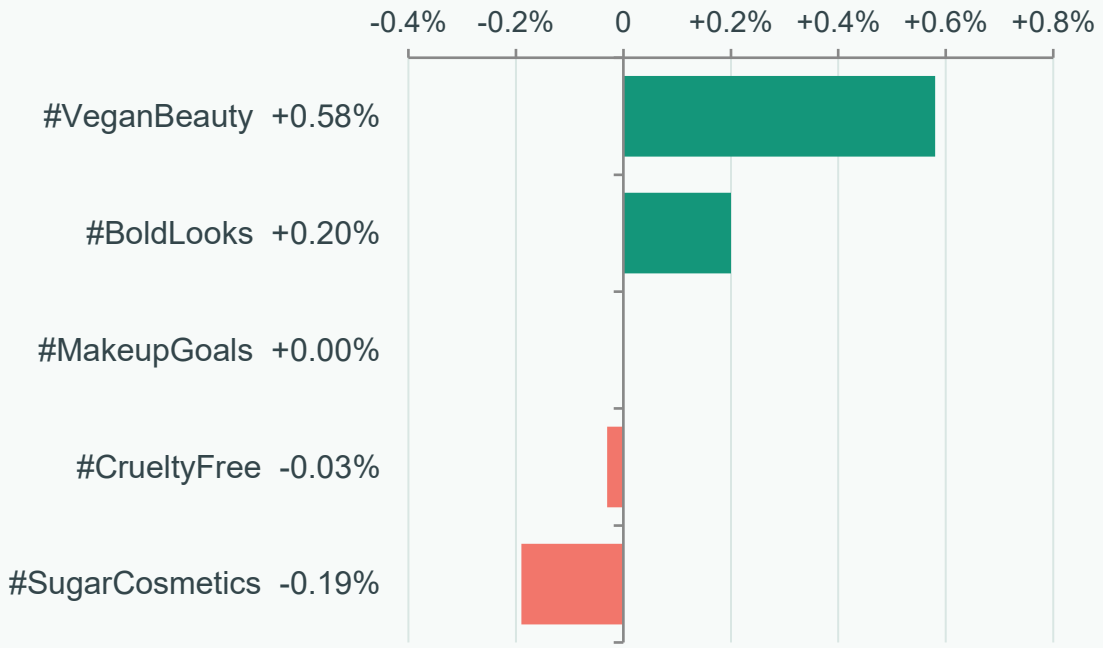
Format × campaign	Weighted ER
▲ Story + Tutorial	18.85%
▲ Reel + Influencer Collab	18.84%
▲ Video + Tutorial	18.69%
▲ Video + Product Launch	18.65%
▼ Image + Product Launch	18.39%
▼ Image + Festive Offer	18.20%

Tutorials appear 3% more often among top-quartile posts than expected; Festive Offers 3% less often.

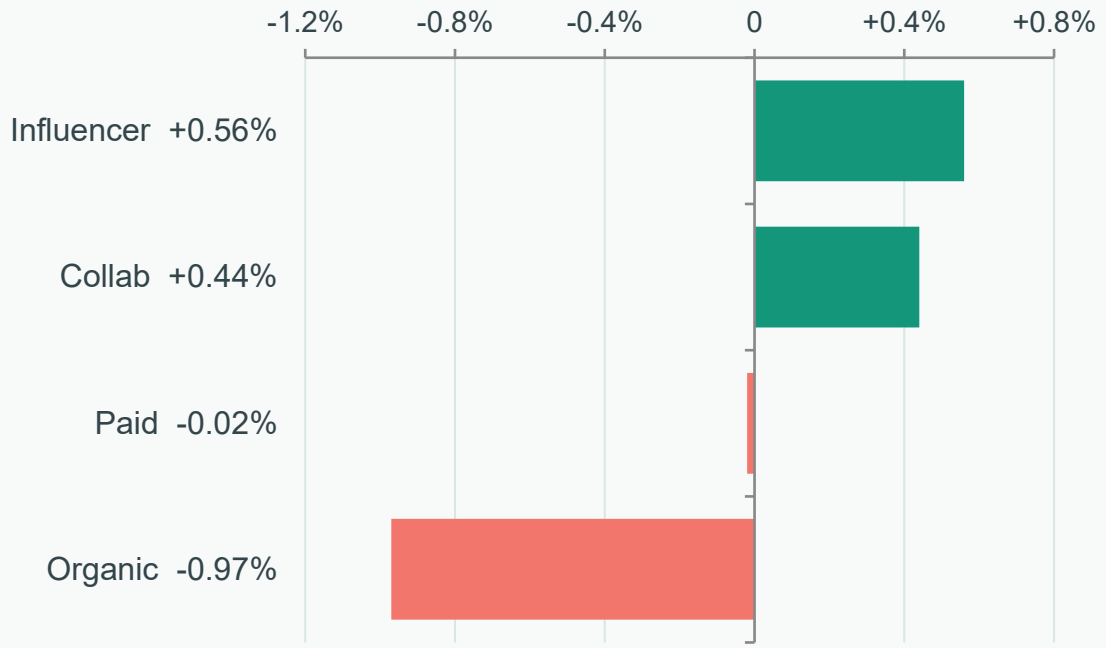
INSIGHT 4 · HASHTAGS & SOURCES

#VeganBeauty earns most; organic trails partner posts

ER vs account average, by hashtag



ER vs account average, by source



2 hashtags per post: 18.65% ER vs 18.44% with a single tag. Paid posts only match the average (−0.02%) — review boost spend.

PLAYBOOK

Do more, do less, test next

Do more

- Story tutorials and Reel creator collabs
- Friday / Saturday for key launches
- 2 focused hashtags: #VeganBeauty, #BoldLooks
- "Save this look" and "send to a friend" prompts

Do less

- Static-image festive offers
- Single-hashtag posts
- Boosting posts without a proven ER
- Pure product shots with no how-to angle

Test next

- Carousel how-to posts (tag as own format)
- Posting hour (needs timestamp data)
- Paid boosts only on top-ER hidden gems
- Comment-to-enter shade-match giveaways

ROADMAP

30-60-90 day plan to deepen engagement

1

Days 1–30

Quick wins

Save/share CTA on every tutorial · move festive offers to Reels & Stories · standardise on 2 hashtags

2

Days 31–60

New formats

Weekly Saturday Story Tutorial series · monthly #BoldLooks creator collab · weekly save & share tracking

3

Days 61–90

Optimise spend

Shift paid budget to top-5% ER posts · review results and reset targets

90-day targets: save rate 0.90% → 1.2% · profile visits 3.0% → 4.0% of reach · ER above 18.8%

Data gaps to close next

Caption text · posting hour · ad spend · follower history · carousel tag

Adding these unlocks keyword, time-of-day and paid-ROI analysis.